

weekly coupon column, pointing out how to combine that week's sales with the Sunday coupons. Plan a strategy for the week's out-of-town shopping trip, if sales warrant it. (*approximately 1 hour*)  
Additional work on column. (*1 hour*)

**Day 3: Monday:** Complete my revised and final coupon column and submit to the newspaper. Print out list of good deals from various online websites like [www.RefundCents.com](http://www.RefundCents.com). Read other good deal alerts from chat board, jotting down any that sound promising. Clip coupons while watching television. (*Total time spent on coupon-related activities, including column, 2 hours.*)

**Day 4: Tuesday:** The ad for our local grocery store comes out. Scan it for good deals. Check coupon binder for corresponding coupons (*15 minutes*). Shop that afternoon with coupon binder in tow. Use 10–15 coupons, depending upon sale prices and what I find in the clearance cart. (*1 hour*)

**Day 5: Wednesday:** Organize coupon binder. Finalize strategy for out-of town trip. Pick up extra coupons from a teen neighbor who saves them for me. (*30 minutes*)

**Day 6: Thursday:** (Dependent upon day 6 and the deals available that week.) If an out-of-town trip is planned, leave early in the afternoon after the children have completed their schoolwork for the day. Stop at one or two thrift stores, looking for children's clothing, good books, stationery, and pretty baskets for my workshops. Walgreens is usually the next stop, with anywhere from 10–15 coupons redeemed, along with any of the store's register reward coupons that had been triggered at the register by the previous trip's purchase. Ideally, most of the items in my bags are free. Sometimes a Target shopping spree is involved, if the ad